



GeoPortal Help Manual

Mapping Conservation. Preserving Tomorrow.

A practical guide to navigating the Conserva GeoPortal, changing basemaps, managing layers, reading legends, and accessing metadata.

About

Conserva Geoportal

Western Cape Conservation Areas Viewer

Open [Help manual](#) on how to use widgets and tools

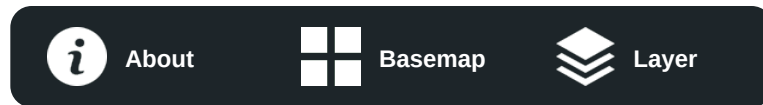
Access comprehensive geospatial data for conservation areas. Monitor, analyze, and protect our natural heritage with advanced mapping tools and spatial insights.

Mapping Conservation. Preserving Tomorrow.

© 2026 APG3039B | Spatial Data Infrastructures
Department of Architecture, Planning and Geomatics
University of Cape Town
Developed by Letelo Chuma and Kwindi Mulalo

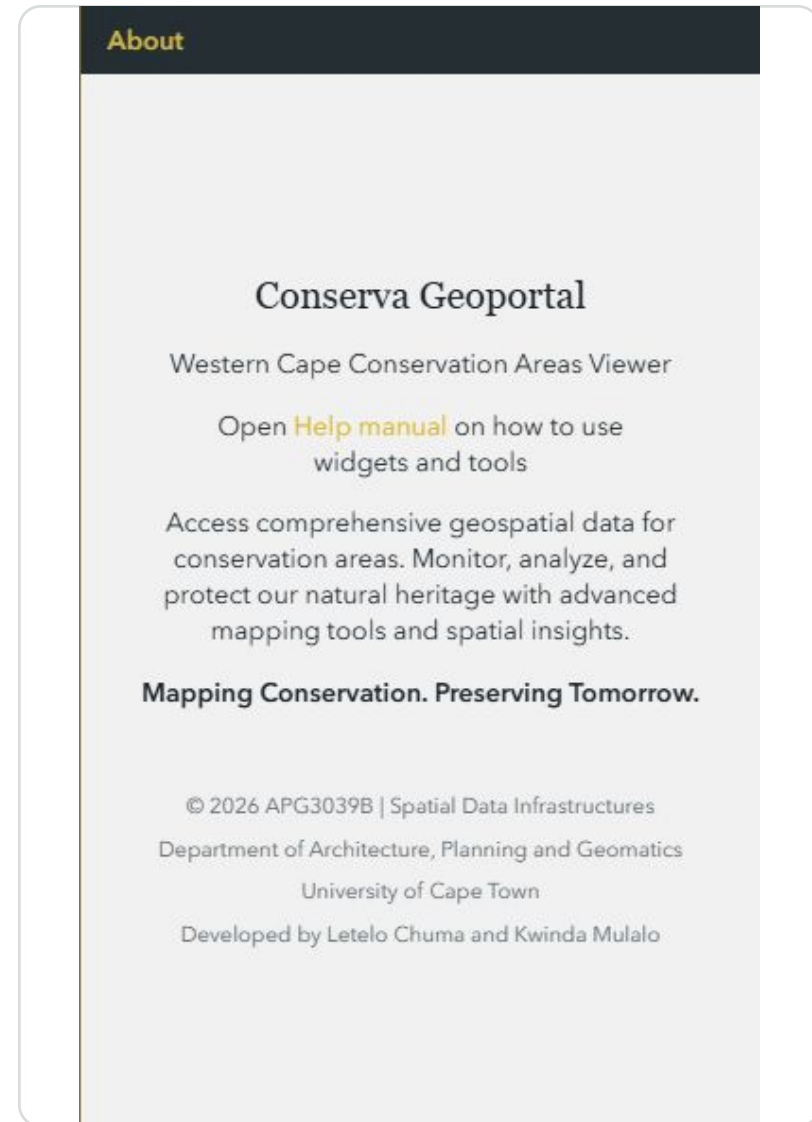
GETTING STARTED

Portal Layout



The portal opens with the map on the left and an information panel on the right. The header tabs control which panel is visible.

- Use the top search bar to find an address or place.
- Use the header icon buttons to move between tools.
- Resize or collapse the right panel with the vertical handle.



MAP BACKGROUND

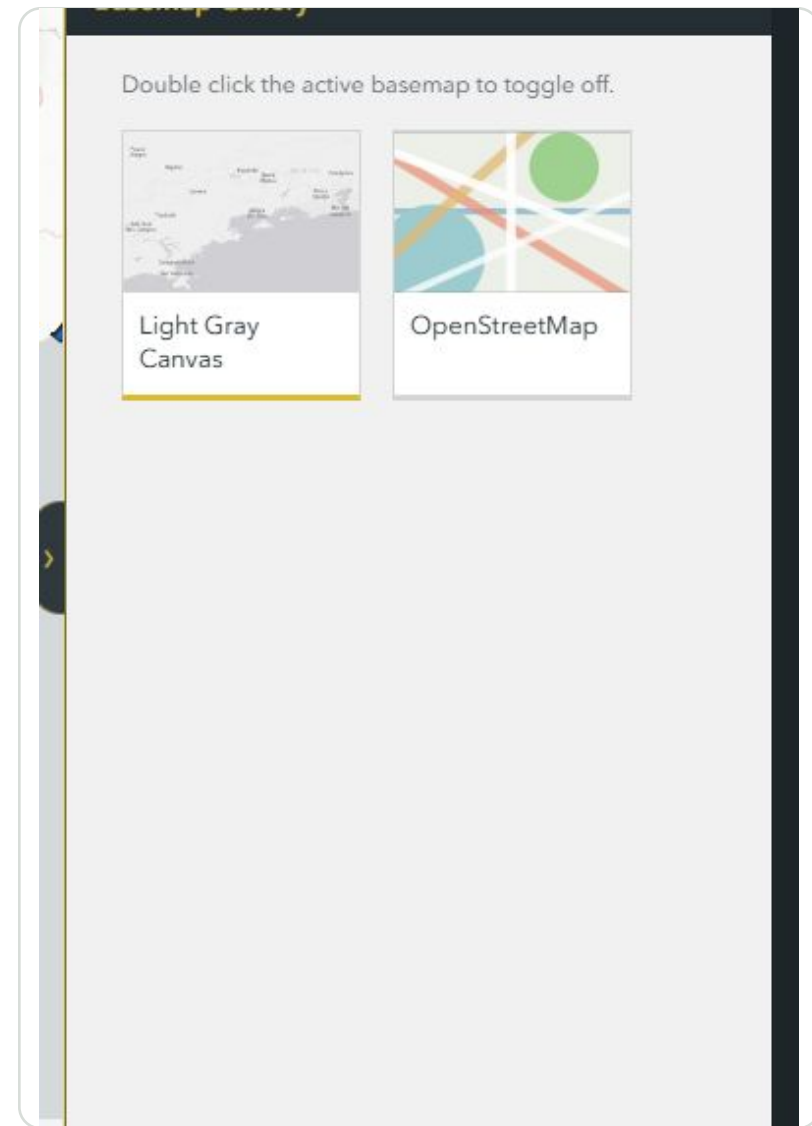
Basemap Gallery



Basemap

Basemaps change the visual context behind the conservation layers without changing the conservation data itself.

- Click a basemap card once to make it active.
- Double click the active basemap to toggle it off.
- Use OpenStreetMap when road and place detail is helpful.



DATA VISIBILITY

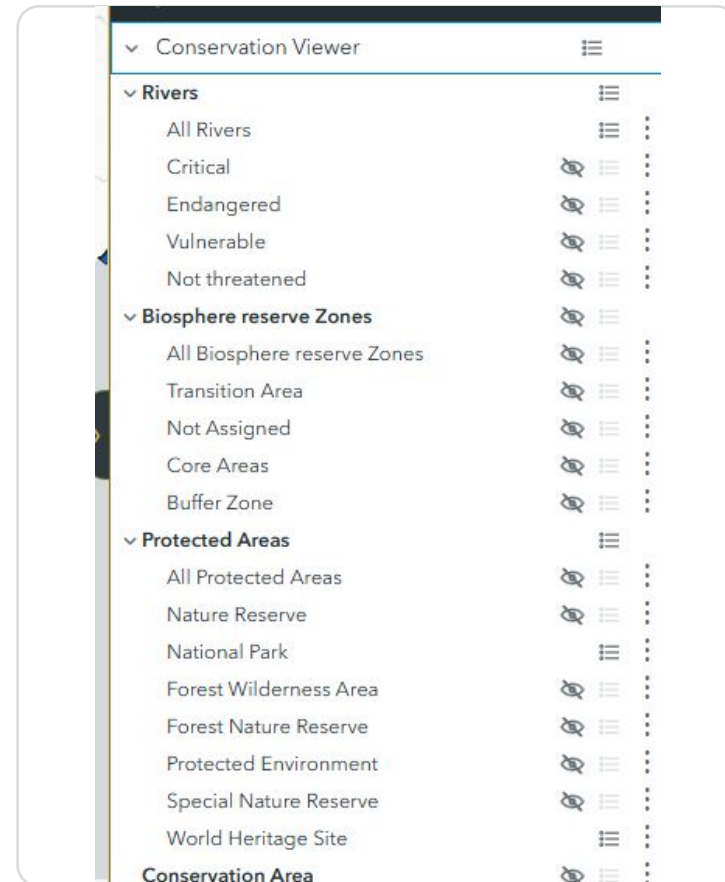
Layer List



Layer

The Layer List controls which conservation datasets appear on the map. It also gives access to layer symbols and export links.

- Expand a group to see individual datasets inside it.
- Turn layers on or off before reading the map.
- Use the layer menu when you need to export or download a layer form.



Layer control symbols



Down arrow

Expand or collapse grouped layers.



Eye

Show or hide a dataset on the map.



Legend icon

Open the symbol preview for a visible layer.



Three dots

Open the layer menu. Export downloads the layer form.

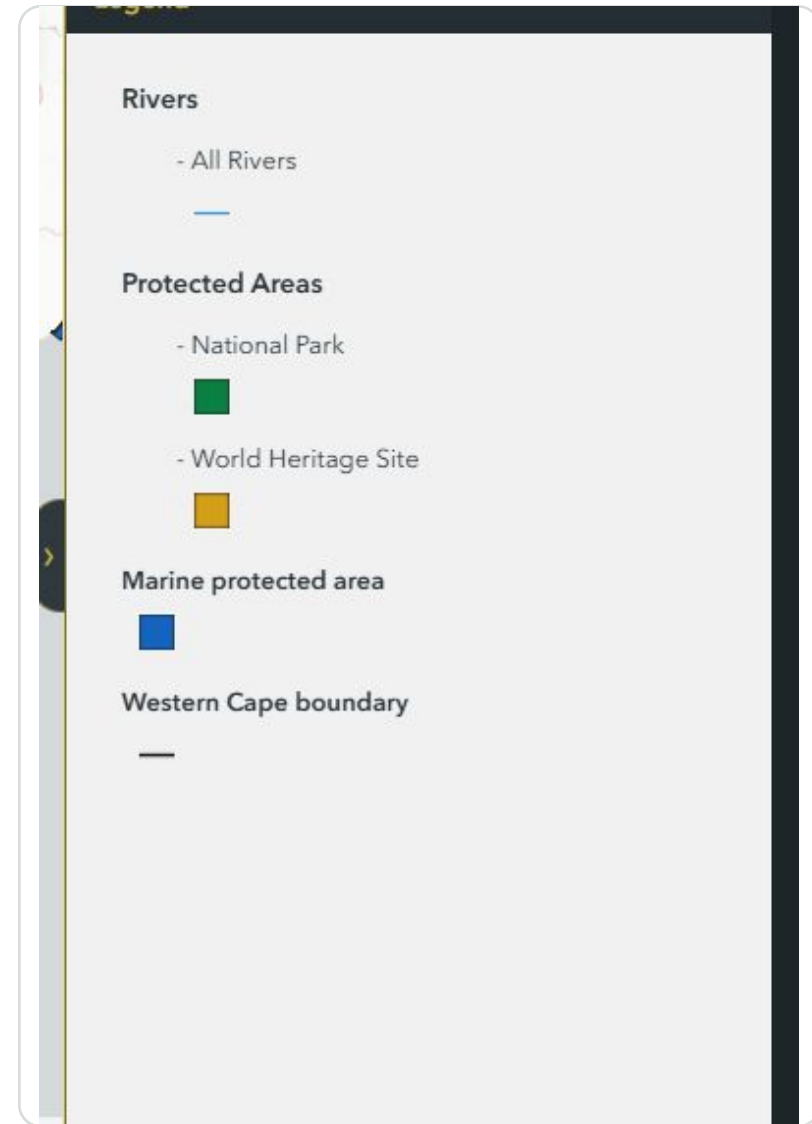
MAP SYMBOLS

Legend



The Legend explains the colors and symbols used by the visible map datasets.

- Open the Legend tab when comparing multiple layers.
- Hidden layers are removed from the legend display.
- Use the legend together with the Layer List for clearer map reading.



DATASET SOURCES

Metadata



Metadata

The Metadata panel lists dataset names and source links. Gold text means a metadata record is available. Text that is not gold means the portal does not currently have metadata for that dataset.

- Click a gold dataset link to open its metadata record.
- Use metadata records to confirm source information and downloads.
- Non-gold dataset names are listed for context, but they do not link to metadata yet.

Click to view or download metadata

- Rivers

Critical

Endangered

Vulnerable

Not threatened

- Biosphere reserve Zones

Transition Area

Not Assigned

Core Areas

Buffer Zone

- Protected Areas

Nature Reserve

National Park

Forest Wilderness Area

Forest Nature Reserve

Protected Environment

Special Nature Reserve

World Heritage Site

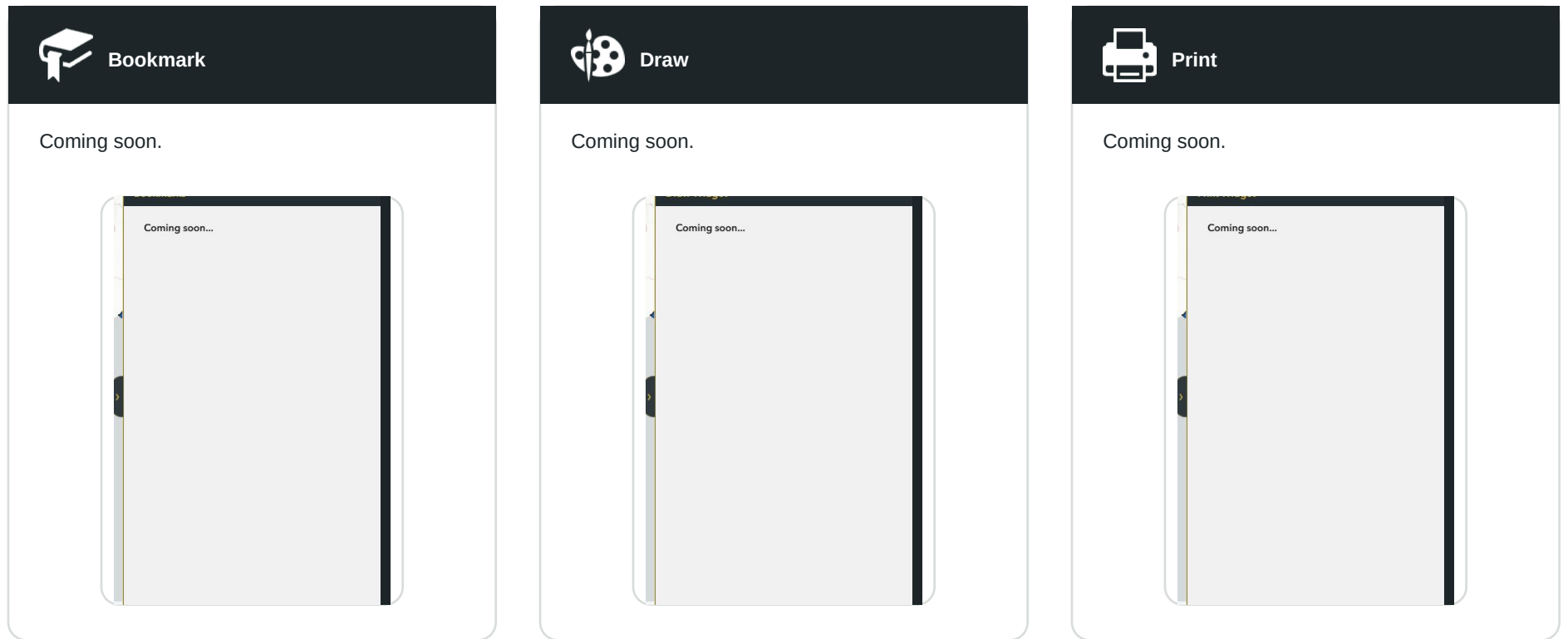
- Conservation Area

- Ecological support area

- Offshore focus areas

Upcoming Tools

Bookmark, Draw, and Print are already enabled in the portal header. Each opens its panel and currently shows Coming soon.



Quick Reference

The tools below match the header icons used in the portal.

 About Project overview and credits.	 Basemap Switch the map background.	 Layer Control data visibility and layer exports.	 Legend Read visible map symbols.
 Bookmark Coming soon.	 Draw Coming soon.	 Print Coming soon.	 Metadata Open available metadata links.

Metadata note

Gold metadata text is clickable. Non-gold metadata text identifies data that is present in the portal but does not currently have a metadata link.